

Artificial Intelligence and Its Strain on Modern Marketing Professionals

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Introduction

With the help of digital platforms and social media, AI software, and data analytics, the marketing field has been dominated by technology and has put marketing professionals in a stressful work environment due to constant creative turnover and rapid skill shift needs. While marketing used to be a more creative, customer-facing industry, it has increasingly turned into a matter of technological fluency and data management. McKinsey Global Institute (2018) predicts skill sets seeing a heavier shift into the technological side, increasing by about 50% before 2030, characterizing the pressure put on fashion marketers with the expectation and necessity to adapt and excel with this change in order to survive in the field. Additionally, with the integration of AI, “21% of marketers identified a skill gap, 20% report data overloads, and 18% state that they are overwhelmed with options as AI tools expand through their career” (IRE Journals, 2023). These findings begin to demonstrate that artificial intelligence integration is producing occupational strain, and a restructuring of skill sets needed. Marketers are not simply adapting to new technological tools but are expected to navigate skill deficiencies while protecting brand image and identity. This projected increase of technological change signifies the structural redefinition that marketing professionals will see in their roles, in which analytical and digital competencies will become a higher priority rather than creative specialty.

This increased pressure from expected assimilation to the change of technological pace, in addition to the fear of employment being taken by artificial intelligence, is persistently growing. Fashion Sustainability Directory (2025) claims that AI algorithms could potentially be used to “dictate design trends and aesthetic preferences,” which puts fashion marketers at risk of replacement and unemployment. If these generative algorithmic systems gain the ability to identify and predict aesthetic preferences, the roles of marketing professionals become less stable

in relation to brand direction and development of marketing strategies. With such a heavy presence in the current marketing side of fashion, artificial intelligence is making job roles in the fashion industry quite difficult to succeed in. Specifically, the integration of artificial intelligence in marketing is now restructuring professional roles through the introduction of algorithmic bias and data instability, the diminishing of creative authority, and how AI forces marketing professionals to devote their increasing labor load to data oversight and correction of AI-generated marketing strategies, rather than developing original brand image and narratives.

Argument and Problem

Artificial intelligence integration has been a “threat” to companies across hundreds of industries that are now being taken over with technology, and fashion marketing has taken a large hit as well. These AI tools are now used to conduct general market research, generate content and marketing media, and conduct market targeting studies, ultimately changing the structure of how marketing is executed. Instead of being used as supplementary tools, these artificial intelligence systems are playing an increasingly larger role in decision-making processes. Specifically pertaining to marketing as an industry, the integration of artificial intelligence into market-based research is inaccurate, compiled, and lacking in brand individuality (Expert Panel, 2024). When AI compiles data patterns specifically for an output, the generalization of said outputs result in the prioritization of efficiency before creativity and originality. In the fashion marketing realm, this homogenization of data weakens brand identity, when brand differentiation is essential to customers.

When AI is used to generate marketing content, brand communication and image become homogenized, which weakens distinct creative voice that marketers rely upon for differentiation. Fashion Sustainability Directory (2025) further argues that brand voice and business statements

are compromised when AI is used as a primary form of marketing for quality content and risks tampering with brand image, which ultimately affects the consumer. This suggests that AI does not just assist in aesthetic direction; it can reshape an entire brand's identity, direction, and authenticity. While the risk of company image being altered and brand goals becoming unclear due to these technological advancements, the inaccuracy of current AI models poses another large threat. Because AI databases are not immune to bias, it can lead to "skewed marketing strategies that overlook or misinterpret segments of the target audience" (CMSWire, 2024, sec. Skewed Marketing Strategies). Bias introduces performance volatility as marketing campaigns put together with incomplete and distorted datasets from generative AI then requires double-checking and human correction before publishing/releasing said campaigns.

Research on algorithmic marketing demonstrates that bias emerges from AI even when campaigns and strategies are designed as entirely neutral. In a study on digital ad delivery analysis, Lambrecht and Tucker found that AI-driven advertising algorithms showed STEM career advertisements to "20% more men than women, more so if they were younger," despite the advertisement campaign being intentionally gender neutral (Lambrecht & Tucker, 2019). This biased outcome occurred due to the algorithms optimization of ad delivery based on cost-efficiency and predictions of engagement, which illustrates how AI generated marketing systems can unintentionally reinforce inequalities in demographics. Additionally, evidence of this algorithmic bias has been observed in Facebook's advertising systems. Researchers analyzing Meta's advertisement delivery systems found that the platform disproportionately targeted Black users with ads of for-profit colleges, "because of their... history of deceiving prospective students—particularly students of color... with predatory marketing" (The Intercept, 2024). This finding further demonstrates how AI-generated marketing tools can reinforce racial

inequalities by directing specific content to specific demographical groups. While AI is intended to make the roles of marketing professionals much easier, this intended reduction of labor shifts the roles of marketers from creatives and creators to system and compliance auditors. Both The Intercept (2024), and Lambrecht & Tucker (2019) prove how algorithmic systems reproduce and follow existing structural biases. Applied to marketing segmentation, similar contortions of data can lead to consumer group misrepresentation, audience marginalization, and inaccurate purchase behavior prediction.

Beyond algorithmic bias, artificial intelligence introduces an additional complication: the production of AI-slop, which are synthetic marketing strategies and content, and research outputs appearing credible when in reality, require extensive human verification. Mukherjee (2024) demonstrates how generative AI platforms are becoming capable of producing “deepfakes,” or highly realistic marketing datasets and materials with the ability of disrupting research without sufficient oversight. Since these systems generate outputs through prediction patterns and consumer bias rather than verifying factual accuracy, this fabricated information enters the marketing analytics processes and influences strategic decision-making. This study by Mukherjee warns that amounts, even limited, of AI-generated content disrupts analytical reliability as traditional mechanisms struggle to authenticate real data from synthetic material (Mukherjee, 2024).

For marketers, this problem transforms AI from a time-saving tool to an additional layer of responsibility and oversight. Instead of seeing an acceleration in strategy development, the generated datasets must be validated and corrected before they are integrated into branding and audience targeting. This additional verification expands the marketing professionals labor by altering marketers roles towards overseers and supervisors, and requires them to evaluate

credibility of the systems outputting the consumer data, but also the evaluation of the consumer data itself. In result, AI increases the cognitive workload by introducing uncertain risk into marketing processes that previously relied on human judgement and creativity. This necessity of monitoring the AI-generated outputs reinforces broader restructuring of marketing skillsets, in which the expected efficiency gains from AI are offset by the growing demand for verification and oversight. These studies illustrate that the issue with AI is not simply its presence in marketing systems, but the increasing dependence on algorithmic decision-making and the constant verification and correction of outputted data and bias.

The overall outcome of artificial intelligence integration into the marketing industry is detrimental to multiple components of a brand's message, goal, and audience. McKinsey states that this increase in technological skills will see a large incline in demand while also adding onto/altering the skills needed in fields with emerging AI platforms (Bughin et al., 2018). With this projected trend is correlated with the growth of AI-generated content, it is clear that the hierarchy of valuable skills is not evolving but being structurally reorganized. Whether AI is at risk of taking jobs, altering a company message, or putting marketing employees in stressful work environments, the rapid technological growth over the past few years has tolled the marketing industry. This embedding of AI causes professionals to constantly adapt to evolving change in technological tools, which redefines job roles, minimizes efficiency, and ultimately causes brand vulnerability; vulnerability does not appear from AI's existence in current commercial platforms, but from its integration into creativity-dominated fields.

Possible Solutions

While the technological change we have seen is irreversible in the realm in which technology will always continue to advance and improve, AI can still be used in marketing for positive outcomes if it is used in analytical fashion rather than as a replacement of creative labor. The research gathered doesn't imply that artificial intelligence needs to be entirely removed from marketing practices; rather, it conveys that the current focus on AI needs intentional implementation and set guidelines within its use. With a proper balance of "AI and human input... companies can leverage AI in marketing to achieve better results" (Szczesny, 2024). However, the IRE Journals (2023) statistics indicate data overload and gaps in skill sets suggest a required balance in investment and training rather than just implementation (Chowhan et al., 2023). Since 21% of marketers already identify a skill gap, integration without education can worsen this instability, when it should be resolving it. This balance reshapes AI to be more of a supplementary mechanism instead of a replacement strategy which can help preserve creative authority in marketing, while utilizing its computational skills when it comes to efficiency. Rather than using AI as an entire software business model, this artificial intelligence is most effective when it is applied to specific target functions like data/market analysis, data personalization, and search engines, allowing marketing professionals to optimize the outcomes of AI in marketing without getting rid of creative labor. Restricting AI to primarily analytical tasks gives companies to keep brand voice intact, and minimizes the risks outlined by Forbes (2024), including misalignment, compromised brand voice, and reputational damage (Expert Panel, 2024)

A key aspect of smart automation and AI is its use for specialization of labor, inventory, and analytics. Rather than taking jobs from a creativity-based industry, AI is better used where human labor is wasted. In fashion marketing, the difference between analytical efficiency and

creative authority McKinsey says that way, “Jobs that remain will tend to be concentrated in customer service, management, and technology deployment and maintenance” (Bughin et al., 2018). Alongside Szczesny’s (2024) emphasis on balance between AI and human collaboration, it suggests how marketers require a repositioning as strategic technological supervisors rather than a displaced employee. As CMSWire (2024) states how these AI databases aren’t bias immune and are capable of producing “skewed marketing strategies,” they prove that companies need to implement methods of oversight in these generated marketing strategies and campaigns (Szczesny, 2024). Implementation of structured review process protects brand integrity, and vets these AI outputs for bias. This further demonstrates how, with the restriction of AI to more analytical tasks rather than creative tasks, companies can improve their own effectiveness in their marketing, all while making sure essential, creative human labor stays centered to the creative processes in the fashion marketing industry. While the impression that artificial intelligence has made in marketing fields, the negative impact of AI can be addressed with a recalibration of authority rather than altogether rejecting this technology. When this AI is limited to data-centered operations and is overseen for mistakes and biases, it can be used to enhance efficiency within a brand or company and can be used in many other positive manners. However, without this call to recalibrate AI’s general authority, marketing professionals will continue to risk further erosion of the creative control that exists in their jobs.

Conclusion

Ultimately, the swift integration of AI into the marketing industry has fundamentally changed the professional realities of marketing professionals by reshaping creative authority, required skill sets, and brand authority and authenticity. What once functioned as an industry led by creatives and consumer-oriented professionalism has increasingly become redefined due to

algorithmic oversight, technological fluency, and constant adaptation to these changing AI systems. This expansion of generative AI has not introduced new tools to marketing professionals but has redistributed responsibilities within marketing roles, requiring professionals to self-manage skill gaps, data overload, and oversight of biased and inaccurate outputs. As we see these AI systems influence brand messaging, consumer targeting, and trend forecasting, marketing professionals will face increased pressure to preserve brand identity and authenticity within environments that are now favoring efficiency and generative prediction. These softwares and AI platforms risk brand identity and consumer trust weakens as automation is replacing creative power and judgement. Additionally, research shows that one of the greatest challenges associated with AI emerge from unchecked authority in creative decision-making, rather than just from the existence of the technology itself. As AI predicts and dictates aesthetic direction and consumer targeting, marketers are repositioned from creatives to overseers of artificially generated work which increases occupational strain and diminishes creative authority. If marketing were to remain sustainable and human-led, AI must be confined to data-centric and analytical functions so that humans can take back creative control over brand image and cultural interpretation. With this structured oversight and human-centered implementation, marketers can take back creative authority and ensure the strength that technological innovation should bring about, rather than replacing the human insight that defines the marketing industry.

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